

Unleash the better coder in you

If you believe in this mantra and want to write code in any language in the most optimal manner - then this book is perfect for you. There's a lot more to coding than just button mashing (albeit, intelligent, specialised button mashing) to get things done. You might be new to programming or have just ventured beyond what's taught in classrooms. In that case, shed your perceptions, developed over years under the influence of popular culture, that writing good code is all about spending hours at a terminal simply splurging out line after line of Java, PHP or whichever language you chose.

And in case you are an experienced developer yet inexperienced in the concept of best practices of software development, it is a wonder that you've still survived in the world of programming. Unless you're working as a lone wolf, it is of paramount importance to follow certain guidelines at each and every stage of software development right from the inception of the idea to the final product itself.

To begin with, you can't just go out there and say, for instance, "I want a travel website" or "I want a translation software". You have to specify (or understand) exactly what your project needs to achieve, in quantifiable, discreet terms that, in turn, can be explained to other developers and testers in your team.

There are methodologies that you can use to your advantage and even they come with their own set of best practices. And when it comes down to the design, a simple bad architectural choice could throw the whole project into jeopardy down the line. For instance, did you know that a 46¢ computer chip had almost caused the third world war?